# Weekly Care Dashboard



*One page. Two minutes to read. Ten minutes to fill in once a week. Photograph it and send it to your backup.*

Week of | Parent | Filled in by | Overall this week ☐ G ☐ Y ☐ R

## THIS WEEK'S TOP 3 (the only things that must happen)

Priority 1 | Priority 2 | Priority 3

## APPOINTMENTS AND CALLS

| Day / time | Who / where | Who goes and drives | Prep sheet done? | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | ☐ | |
| | | | ☐ | |
| | | | ☐ | |
| | | | ☐ | |

## TASKS (one owner per task, always)

| Task | OWNER (one name) | Backup | Due | Done |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | ☐ |
| | | | | ☐ |
| | | | | ☐ |
| | | | | ☐ |
| | | | | ☐ |
| | | | | ☐ |

## WHAT CHANGED? (check one per row; skip any that are the same)

| Area | Better | Same | Worse | One line: what, and when it started |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Walking / balance / falls** | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| **Eating, drinking, weight** | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| **Sleep** | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| **Mood / anxiety** | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| **Memory / thinking** | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| **Pain / new symptoms** | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| **Pills taken as planned** | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |
| **Home, mail, money, scams** | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | |

**Worse in any row?** Open the decision trees (pages 4 and 5). **Sudden?** Call the doctor today. Not sure? Go one color up.

Refills due / medicine changes this week | Questions to carry to the next appointment

☐ **1. Look back**
2 min: fill in **What changed?**

☐ **2. Look ahead**
3 min: appointments, refills, calls

☐ **3. Assign**
3 min: every task has **one** owner

☐ **4. Share**
2 min: photo of this page to your backup and family

# Appointment Prep and Visit Notes

*One sheet per visit. Fill in the top before. Use the bottom in the parking lot afterward.*

Date and time

Doctor / clinic / phone

Who is going / driving

Reason for the visit, in one sentence

## TOP CONCERNS (most important first; plan on getting through three or four)

1

2

3

4

## WHAT CHANGED SINCE THE LAST VISIT

Falls, ER or urgent care visits

Medicine changes (from any doctor, or stopped on their own)

Eating, weight, sleep, mood, memory (from the dashboard)

New symptoms and when each started

## BRING

- [ ] Insurance cards
- [ ] Emergency Quick Sheet (binder page 2)
- [ ] Health care POA / HIPAA release copy
- [ ] Pen and notebook (ask before recording)
- [ ] Medication list (binder page 3) or the bottles
- [ ] Glasses, hearing aids, dentures
- [ ] Dashboards and incident log (binder page 11)
- [ ] Other doctors' names and recent results

## ASK ABOUT ANYTHING NEW (check the ones you asked)

- [ ] What is this for, and what happens if we wait?
- [ ] What is the next step, who schedules it, and by when?
- [ ] What are the side effects, and does it mix with the current medicines?
- [ ] Who do I call with questions, and what is the after-hours number?

## DURING AND AFTER THE VISIT (three minutes in the parking lot)

What the doctor said (main points, any diagnosis)

Medicine changes (add to binder page 3)

Tests or referrals: who schedules, by when

Next appointment

Warning signs to call about

- [ ] I repeated the plan back in my own words
- [ ] Told my backup / sibling
- [ ] Updated binder page 3 and the dashboard
- [ ] Added follow-ups to the shared calendar

# Who Owns What: Tasks and Shared Calendar



*One owner per task. One calendar. One weekly update. Agree on it once, then stop re-deciding.*

## WHO OWNS WHAT

| Area | Owner | Backup | How and when |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Appointments and rides** | | | |
| **Medicines and refills** | | | |
| **Bills, insurance, mail** | | | |
| **Home, safety, repairs** | | | |
| **Check-in calls (how often)** | | | |
| **Legal papers and the binder** | | | |
| **Updates to the family** | | | |
| **Other** | | | |

## SHARED CALENDAR SET-UP (check as you go)

- ☐ Create one shared calendar named for your parent (for example, "Dad's care"). Invite siblings and your backup person.
- ☐ Put every appointment on it with the address, who is driving, and 30 minutes of prep time (use the Appointment Prep sheet).
- ☐ Add refill dates, the weekly 10-minute review, and the monthly binder check (binder page 12).
- ☐ Give each owner a color so everyone can see who has what at a glance.
- ☐ Set reminders: two days before appointments, and one day before any ride someone has promised.
- ☐ Choose one place for messages (one group chat) and one place for documents (the binder plus one shared folder).

Calendar name and where it lives

Group chat name

Weekly update day and time

## GROUND RULES (edit them together, then keep them)

**1.** Whoever claims a task owns it until they hand it off out loud.
**2.** Every task has one name and one date. "We" is not an owner.
**3.** Routine updates go in the weekly message, not in fourteen texts.
**4.** Urgent means a phone call. If it is red, call 911 first and the family second.
**5.** The owner decides *how*. The family decides *what* at the monthly check-in.

Our rule #6

Our rule #7

Next family check-in (date, time, who hosts)

# Decision Trees (1 of 2)

*Start at the top. Stop at the first YES. If you are unsure, go one color up (the Chapter 2 rule).*

## TREE 1: SOMETHING IS DIFFERENT TODAY

**Any of these?** Stroke signs (BE-FAST: sudden loss of Balance, Eyes/vision change, Face drooping, Arm weakness, Speech trouble); chest pain or pressure; severe trouble breathing; cannot be woken; severe bleeding; a seizure; a fall with severe pain, or a head injury with drowsiness or vomiting.

YES → **RED: Call 911 now.** Note the time symptoms started. Do not drive them yourself. Unlock the door, gather the Quick Sheet and medicine list (binder page 2 and 3), then call the family.

NO ↓

**Any of these?** New confusion or "not themselves"; fever; any fall, especially a head strike on a blood thinner; new pain; not eating or drinking for a day; new trouble or pain urinating; missed insulin, blood thinner, or seizure medicine.

YES → **YELLOW: Call the doctor today.** Use the after-hours line. Say: "This is a sudden change from their normal." Head strike on a blood thinner: go to the ER today, even if they seem fine. No call back in an hour, or getting worse: urgent care, ER, or 911.

NO ↓

**None of these,** but something is slowly different (more tired, eating less, more forgetful, wobblier)?

YES → **GREEN: Log it.** Check Worse on the dashboard with the date it started. Raise it at the next appointment. Still there next week? Move it up to yellow.

## TREE 2: I CANNOT REACH MY PARENT

**Is this unusual?** Do they normally answer by now?

YES → Call once more and text. If no answer in 15 minutes, go to the next question. (Answering late is not an emergency; a pattern is worth a conversation.)

NO ↓

**Has your backup person checked?** A neighbor or key holder (binder page 9) knocks, calls out, and looks in a window.

YES → Ask them to call you from the doorstep. They see your parent down, or hear no response? **Call 911.** Door locked and no answer? Go to the next question.

NO ↓

**No backup, or backup cannot get in?**

YES → **Call the local police (non-emergency line) or 911 and ask for a welfare check.** Give the address, how to get in, and any health risk. Then keep calling and head over if you are close.

**The colors, in one line.** **Red** = call 911. **Yellow** = call a clinician today. **Green** = write it down and bring it to the next visit. Not sure? Go one color up.

# Decision Trees (2 of 2)

*Medicine problems and "I don't need help." Both connect back to earlier chapters.*

## TREE 3: A MEDICINE PROBLEM

**Too much, a double dose, or someone else's pill?** Or drowsy, hard to wake, trouble breathing, or very confused afterward?

YES → **Collapsed, not breathing normally, or seizing: call 911.** Otherwise call Poison Help at **1-800-222-1222** (free, 24 hours, United States) and follow what they say. Keep the bottles in front of you.

NO ↓

**Missed doses of insulin, a blood thinner, heart medicine, or seizure medicine?**

YES → **Call the pharmacist or prescriber today.** Do not double up unless they tell you to. Note what was missed and why on the dashboard.

NO ↓

**Missed an ordinary or occasional dose, or confused about which pill is which?**

YES → Check the label, call the pharmacist, and log it. Ask about a pill organizer, blister packs, or syncing refills. Write the fix on the dashboard under tasks, with an owner.

## TREE 4: "I DON'T NEED HELP" (REFUSING A DOCTOR, A RIDE, OR A CHANGE)

**Is there a red or yellow safety risk right now** (Tree 1)?

YES → Act on Tree 1 first. Conversations come later. A parent's right to refuse does not mean you wait out an emergency.

NO ↓

**Can they understand the choice, weigh it, and explain their reasoning?** (Capacity is decision-specific; see Chapter 6.)

YES → **Respect the decision.** Name your worry once, then offer a smaller step and a trial period (LEAP, Chapter 5). Write the date to revisit in two weeks on the dashboard.

NO ↓

**Not sure, or the reasoning keeps changing?**

YES → Ask the doctor for a capacity assessment for this specific decision. Bring your notes from the dashboard and the incident log (binder page 11). Chapter 6 has the ladder of least-restrictive steps.

**Take these to the doctor.** The trees are a starting point written for family caregivers. They do not replace a clinician. At the next visit, ask your parent's doctor to review them and add specifics for your parent's conditions (for example, what weight change, blood sugar number, or blood pressure reading should trigger a call).

# Emergency Handoff Sheet



*If you are out for a day or a week, a stranger should be able to run the day from this page. Write it while things are calm.*

Parent's name | Written by (and phone) | Date and time written

Covering person (name, phone) | Covering from / to

## 1. HOW STABLE ARE THINGS RIGHT NOW?

☐ Stable ☐ Watch closely ☐ **Unstable: call the doctor first, then read the rest**

What I am watching for this week

## 2. WHO THEY ARE (the three-line version)

Conditions, and how they normally walk, talk, and think

What helps, and what upsets them (foods, routines, topics)

## 3. THE DAY (what a normal day looks like)

Morning | Midday | Evening | Night

Medicines that must not be missed, and where the pill organizer is (full list: binder page 3)

## 4. TO DO WHILE I AM AWAY

| What | By when | Who | Done |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | ☐ |
| | | | ☐ |
| | | | ☐ |
| | | | ☐ |

## 5. IF THIS HAPPENS, DO THIS

| | |
|---|---|
| Stroke signs, chest pain, trouble breathing, cannot wake, severe bleeding, seizure | **Call 911.** Then call me and the family. |
| Fall, new confusion, fever, not eating or drinking, missed key medicine | **Call the doctor today** (after-hours number in binder page 4). ER if unsure. |
| Cannot reach them by phone | Call the backup neighbor (binder page 9). Then ask police for a welfare check. |
| **Our own if / then** | |
| | |

## 6. WHO TO CALL AND WHERE THINGS ARE

Doctor and after-hours number | Pharmacy | Backup person #1 | Backup person #2

Binder / spare key | Insurance cards / legal papers

## 7. READ-BACK (the person covering says it back before I leave)

☐ I can find the binder ☐ I know who to call and when ☐ I read the plan back out loud

Date / time